

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, January 28, 2026, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor William Greenrose
Ward III Councilor Christopher Irish
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Christopher Cogswell
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Jim Chamberlain, Acting City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the January 6, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – abstain

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway –yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstained

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to accept the minutes of the January 14, 2026, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway –yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Claremont Parks and Recreation will be having their Crown Point Pig Skin 5k on Sunday February 8th starting at 11am.

Claremont Winterfest, from February 9th through February 15th, activities are posted on the Claremont Parks website.

Arrowhead Recreation will hold their cardboard sled race Sunday the 15th at noon.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

Acting City Manager, Chamberlain welcomed the new councilors Cogswell, and Irish, then expressed appreciation to Public Works Director, Gleeson and Assistant Director, Wadleigh along with their team doing extremely well in the recent snow events.

There is no correspondence yet from the gridlocked land on Grissom Lane discussed at the January 14th meeting.

Valley Restoration will be installing 12 arch windows in the clock tower on February 2nd.

There is an audible alarm when you walk into City Hall. The fire alarm company has been contacted and is scheduling a repair, the alarm will activate in the event of an issue. SGH contract was executed for the Visitor Center structural engineering and will begin working on February 4th, as of now it has been deemed safe for occupants and general public.

The Human Resource Director has finalized with LinkedIn, and a transfer of funds will be coming to Council at another meeting.

Cathy Parks, Treasurer gave an update for 17 Water Street and stated a final invoice for all transactions has been received the total costs in purchasing was \$765,602.78. The sale price, oil reimbursement, and the costs associated with the closing totaled \$814,332.45, Leaving the net proceeds of the sale as \$48,729.67.

Councilor Koloski asked where the City stands in relation to the regional salt shortage.

Director Gleeson noted there is a delivery from American Rock Salt tomorrow and there is enough in the salt shed to maintain the storm that just happened and a potential storm this weekend.

Councilor O’Hearne asked for a moment of silence for John O’Connor.

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

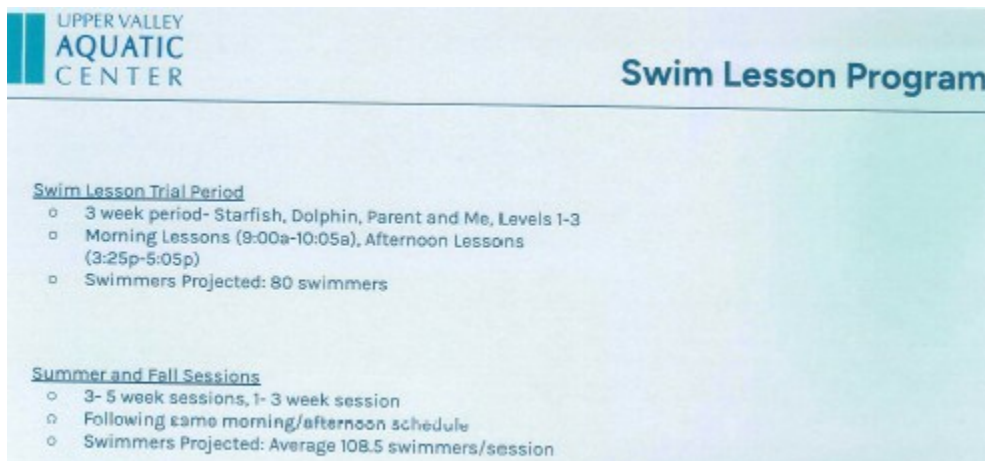
No one spoke, Mayor Girard closed Citizens Forum.

NEW BUSINESS

Upper Valley Aquatic Use of CSBCC Pool Presentation

Director Martin introduced the Upper Valley Aquatic Center representatives Joe Major, Samantha Goveia, and Ian Quinn.

Mayor Girard reminded the Council this was just a presentation from Upper Valley Aquatic Center.



UPPER VALLEY
AQUATIC
CENTER

Swim Lesson Program

Swim Lesson Trial Period

- 3 week period- Starfish, Dolphin, Parent and Me, Levels 1-3
- Morning Lessons (9:00a-10:05a), Afternoon Lessons (3:25p-5:05p)
- Swimmers Projected: 80 swimmers

Summer and Fall Sessions

- 3- 5 week sessions, 1- 3 week session
- Following same morning/afternoon schedule
- Swimmers Projected: Average 108.5 swimmers/session

		Summary of Financials	
<u>CSBCC Total Income</u>		<u>UVAC Total Income</u>	
Lane Rentals \$15/lane/hr (Swim Lesson)	\$6,510	Swim lesson revenue	\$34,741
		Dues & Meet Fees at CSBCC:	<u>\$83,749</u>
Lane Rental Yr 1 \$10/lane/hr for Swim Team: *	<u>\$13,230</u>	Total Revenue	\$118,490
Total:	\$19,740	<u>UVAC Total Expenses:</u>	
		Swim Lesson Expenses: (Lane rentals, instructor wages, training wages, marketing program launch for both programs & then recurring qtrly. Marketing for both, location administrator wages.	\$39,611
		Swim Team Expenses:	<u>\$91,879</u>
*-Year 2+ increase \$2/lane/hour		Total Expense	\$131,490
		<u>UVAC 1st Year NOI:</u>	-\$13,000



Key Takeaways

UVAC Commitments

We are committed to growing with our communities to better the opportunities available to swimmers and families from all different backgrounds, abilities, and wants and needs.

Our role in the Upper Valley has allowed our Aquatic Center to be a foundation to accessible and safe learning environment for our swimmers, and we would be honored to continue this in Claremont.

After the presentation Council discussed topics such as scholarship opportunities, program expansion, pool access, and a concern for paid memberships and not wanting those members to be dislodged. However, this was addressed and noted that lanes for members will still be open.

Resolution 2026-28 Water System Sustainability Program Grant – Public Hearing

Director Gleeson explained this grant has a 50% match and is requesting to move forward.

RESOLUTION 2026-28

Water System Sustainability Grant Program

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after a public hearing duly noticed, that

WHEREAS the Claremont Water Utilities Division would like to accept a grant from the New Hampshire Department of Environmental Services (NHDES) Water System Sustainability Grant Program (WSSGP) for the amount of \$30,000.

WHEREAS these funds will be used to assist in the funding of the Water Treatment Plant Facility Study.

WHEREAS the Water System Sustainability Grant Program, requires local government approval authorizing the grant agreement and certifying the availability of 50% matching funds totaling up to \$15,000.00. These funds will be allocated from the current department operating budget.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to undertake the acceptance of this grant and to approve the spending of these funds.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or his designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 28th day of January 2026, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept Resolution 2026-28.

Councilor Koloski Read Resolution 2026-28 into record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-29 Balance Transfer for Cemetery Repairs – Public Hearing

Treasurer Parks explained more work needed to be done so there were additional costs and is requesting to transfer funds from the cemetery capital reserves to cover it.

RESOLUTION 2026-29

Transfer from Cemetery Capital Reserve for Broad Street Cemetery Repair

WHEREAS the City Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire (the “City Council”) has approved use of Cemetery Capital Reserve funds to repair and restore the pillars and gates at Broad Street Cemetery; and

WHEREAS expenditures related to the Broad Street Cemetery Pillars and Gate have been incurred in excess of the budgeted amount of \$5000.00; and

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council, after public hearing duly noticed, that to have zero impact on the tax rate it hereby authorizes the transfer of funds equal to \$3675.00 from the Cemetery Capital Reserve to cover the above noted expenditures; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED to authorize the City Manager or the Treasurer, or their designees, to withdraw said funds; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or Treasurer or their designees, are hereby authorized to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(2/3 Vote Required)*

Dated this 28th day of January 2026 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept Resolution 2026-29.

Councilor Limoges Read Resolution 2026-29 into record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Cogswell reported CCTV reviewed their budget report. Councilor Cogswell did not attend the Conservation Meeting but reviewed the minutes and reported they reviewed 2026 goals, and the Native Invasive Species Week will be held starting February 23rd and will hold a presentation for the 492 Washington St. project relative to wetlands. The commission will also hold a presentation on single use plastics at the next meeting.

Councilor Greenrose reported that the energy committee discussed recommendations regarding community power, and heard from another group called Frontier Energy Logistics and will present at the February meeting on February 19th.

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted the Planning Board was cancelled this past Monday.

Councilor Koloski reported that the Arts Commission has changed its meeting location and dates to the second Tuesday of the month at the Visitors Center, he noted there will be collection boxes in the lower atrium for the restoration of the Claremont Eagle.

Councilor Limoges reported the CDA has a greenhouse project on industrial park off of Grissom Lane and ended up swapping some land as they had some wetland issues and currently waiting on information from Eversource for power. There was vent work done at the Farewell Block for the Dental Center. The roof is done on 56 Opera House and reported there are issues with the tenant and was sent a notice for compliance with the lease.

Councilor Hemingway reported the Water Sewer Rate Committee narrowed the proposals down to two that were more targeted to the upper valley and there will be another meeting this Friday.

Councilor Irish noted there will be a procurement meeting on February 9th.

Mayor Girard reported that the Airport Committee had a meeting where Chief Chamberlain gave a presentation, and there will be a bid opening for the weather system this Friday at 10 a.m. Due to recent weather the airport had to close down for a few days, there is also an upcoming fuel delivery and repairs for the fuel pump system.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Koloski noted there was a stop sign request from a resident and that will be forwarded to the Traffic Advisory Committee. Councilor Koloski would like to bring Council goals and objectives, sports fees for the community center, and a community center membership update to a future meeting.

Councilor Koloski shared a citizen concern about concluded permits from the planning office not having the same information in assessing. Councilor Koloski also asked everyone to keep an eye out for the transport wheelchair that was in the City Hall atrium.

Councilor Greenrose asked to discuss the process of goals and objectives at the upcoming council training.

Councilor Cogswell asked for future analysis of UVAC relative to parking and associated facility costs and gave an example of increased bathroom use.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:34p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

O’Hearne – yes

Cogswell – yes

Greenrose – yes

Matteau – yes

Koloski – yes

Limoges – yes

Hemingway – yes

Irish - yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council